

You are invited to participate in a survey about politics and public affairs that will take approximately 10 to 15 minutes to complete. You will be asked to answer some questions about yourself and your views on politics.

Your participation in this survey is completely voluntary, and you may skip any question or choose to end your participation at any time without penalty. There are no known or anticipated risks to you for participating. Although this study will not benefit you personally, we hope that our results will add to our knowledge about political attitudes in the United States.

The survey is anonymous. The researcher will not know your name, and no identifying information will be connected to your survey answers in any way.

- ☐ I agree to participate
- ☐ I do not agree to participate



In which state do you live?



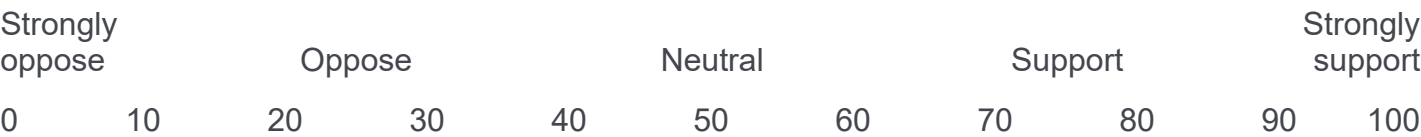
On the next four screens, we will ask you about some of your public policy preferences.

Please state how strongly you would support or oppose each policy in your state.



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How strongly would you support or oppose each policy?



Increase the state income tax on households earning over \$250,000 and increase the state corporate tax.

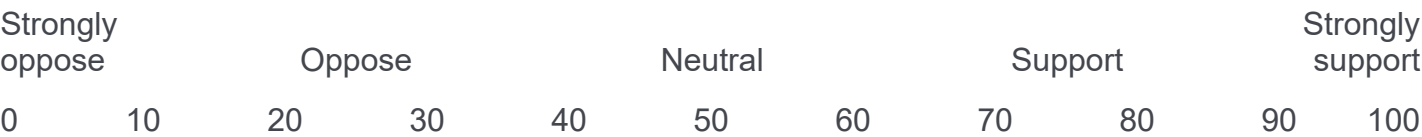
Increase the state income tax on households earning over \$250,000.

Cut the state income tax for all households.

Eliminate the state income tax.



How strongly would you support or oppose each policy?



Local police should not help federal authorities to enforce immigration laws.

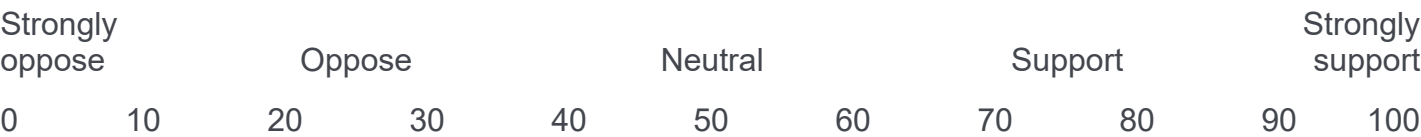
Local police should turn over to federal authorities only illegal immigrants accused of violent crimes.

Local police should turn over to federal authorities every illegal immigrant they encounter.

Local police should aggressively search for illegal immigrants and turn them over to federal authorities.



How strongly would you support or oppose each policy?



Increase state aid to local school districts and prioritize poor school districts.

Increase state aid across all local school districts.

Cut state aid across all local school districts.

Eliminate state aid to local school districts.



How strongly would you support or oppose each policy?

Strongly oppose	Oppose		Neutral		Support		Strongly support			
0	10	20	30	40	50	60	70	80	90	100

Marijuana should be legal for recreational use and sold freely.

Marijuana should be legal for recreational use and only sold in state-licensed dispensaries.

Marijuana should only be legal for medical use.

Marijuana should be illegal for everyone. No exceptions.



Thinking about the policy issues you just rated, how important do you consider each one?

Not at all important	Not too important				Fairly important				Extremely important	
0	10	20	30	40	50	60	70	80	90	100

Education spending

Immigration

Marijuana

Taxes



How important is it for you to live in a country that is governed democratically?

Please choose on a scale where 1 means “not at all democratic” and 10 means “completely democratic.”

Not at all democratic										Completely democratic
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



"Democracy may have problems, but it is better than any other form of government."

To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement?

- ☐ Strongly agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Strongly disagree



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On the whole, are you satisfied with the way democracy works in the United States?

- ☐ Very satisfied
- ☐ Fairly satisfied
- ☐ Not very satisfied
- ☐ Not at all satisfied



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Countries around the world differ in how democratic they are. We sampled the following practices from around the world. How democratic do you think each one is?

Use a scale where 1 means “not at all democratic” and 10 means “completely democratic.”

[illegible]



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Here are some more practices from around the world. How democratic do you think each one is?

Use a scale where 1 means “not at all democratic” and 10 means “completely democratic.”

[illegible]



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As you may know, state legislatures redraw election maps every ten years. This is called *redistricting*. Redistricting ensures that each state legislator and member of Congress represents the same number of people.

Politicians sometimes draw district boundaries to help their party do better. This is called *gerrymandering*. For example, if you draw the map just right, one party might win 70 or 80 percent of the available seats with just 51 percent of the total votes.

How strongly do you support or oppose gerrymandering?

Strongly oppose										Strongly support
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



Many things are desirable, but not all of them are essential characteristics of democracy. On a scale from 1 to 10, how essential for democracy is each of the following things?

	Not at all essential 1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	Essential to democracy 10
Governments tax the rich and subsidize the poor	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Religious authorities ultimately interpret the laws	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
People choose their leaders in free elections	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
People receive state aid for unemployment	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The army takes over when government is incompetent	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Civil rights protect people from state oppression	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The state makes people's incomes equal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
People obey their rulers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Women have the same rights as men	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



Next you will answer some questions about politically-relevant facts.

We want to measure what you **already know** about these questions. Please do not cheat by looking up the answers, asking someone, or getting help in any other way.

Do you promise not to cheat?

- ☐ Yes, I promise not to cheat.
- ☐ No.



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In New York, which party currently controls a majority of the seats in the state legislature?

- ☐ Democrats control both houses
- ☐ Republicans control both houses
- ☐ Split (each party controls one house)
- ☐ Don't know



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In New York, to which party does the governor belong?

- ☐ Democrat
- ☐ Republican
- ☐ Independent
- ☐ Don't know



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Generally speaking, do you think of yourself as a Republican, a Democrat, an Independent, or what?

- ☐ Democrat
- ☐ Republican
- ☐ Independent
- ☐ Other



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Do you think of yourself as closer to the Democratic party or the Republican party?

- ☐ Republican
- ☐ Neither
- ☐ Democrat



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How would you describe your political ideology?

- ☐ Extremely liberal
- ☐ Liberal
- ☐ Slightly liberal
- ☐ Moderate
- ☐ Slightly conservative
- ☐ Conservative
- ☐ Extremely conservative



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How strongly do you agree or disagree with the following statements?

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly agree
A candidate's policies matter more than their political party.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I always vote for Democrats.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Knowing the candidates' parties helps me choose.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I would never vote for a Republican.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I always trust Democrats to do the right thing.	☐	☐	☐	☐



We would like to learn about your views on a series of candidates for a state legislature. Each candidate will have a few policy positions and most will have a political party.

As you rate these candidates, please think about how close each one is to the combination of party and policy positions that you would most like to see in a real candidate.



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[Respondents answered 24 questions in this format]

A Republican with the platform:

- ▶ Cut state aid across all local school districts.
- ▶ Marijuana should be legal for recreational use and only sold in state-licensed dispensaries.

How similar is this candidate to your ideal set of policy views?



Finally, we need a little more background information.



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Are you registered to vote?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ No, I just moved and haven't had a chance
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Other



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Do you approve or disapprove of the way Donald Trump is handling his job as President?

- ☐ Strongly approve
- ☐ Somewhat approve
- ☐ Somewhat disapprove
- ☐ Strongly disapprove



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For whom did you vote in the 2016 presidential election?

☐ Hillary Clinton

☐ Donald Trump

☐ Another candidate

☐ Did not vote



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For whom did you vote in the 2012 presidential election?

☐ Barack Obama

☐ Mitt Romney

☐ Another candidate

☐ Did not vote



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If the 2016 presidential election were held again tomorrow, which major party candidate would you prefer?

- ☐ Hillary Clinton
- ☐ Donald Trump
- ☐ Would not vote



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Thank you for completing the survey.

If you have any questions about this research, you may contact Milan Svolik at milan.svolik@yale.edu or (217) 419-6685.

If you would like to talk with someone other than the researchers to discuss problems or concerns, to discuss situations in the event that a member of the research team is not available, or to discuss your rights as a research participant, you may contact the Yale University Human Subjects Committee, (203)785-4688, human.subjects@yale.edu. Additional information is available at <https://your.yale.edu/research-support/human-research/research-participants/rights-research-participant>.



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